

EBRU KASIKARALAR

ebrukasikaralar@gmail.com

| [linkedin.com/in/ebru-kasikaralar](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ebru-kasikaralar)

| [ekasikaralar.github.io](https://github.com/ekasikaralar)

EMPLOYMENT

Amazon.com, Inc.

Research Scientist II

Seattle, WA

May 2025 – Present

Amazon Customer Service, Network Planning Intelligence

Planning for the world's largest multi-channel customer service network across phone, chat, email, and self-service channels.

Best Innovator & Change Agent Award, Amazon Customer Service, Q3 2025

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Chicago, IL

Ph.D. & MBA in Management Science & Operations Management

2019 – 2025

Minor in Economics

Dissertation: Dynamic Scheduling of Multiclass Queueing Systems in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems

University of California, Berkeley

Berkeley, CA

B.S. in Industrial Engineering and Operations Research (Honors)

2015 – 2019

Certificate in Technology Entrepreneurship

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Service Operations, Deep Learning, Simulation

TEACHING INTERESTS

Operations Management, Managerial Decision Modeling

PUBLICATIONS AND PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- **Dynamic Scheduling of a Multiclass Queue in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems.**
Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar
Management Science 72(7) (2026): 6309–6333.
- **Dynamic Scheduling of a Parallel-Server Queueing System: A Computational Method for High-Dimensional Problems.** *Under review.*
Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar
- **Exploring Cost and Environmental Implications of Optimal Technology Management Strategies in the Street Lighting Industry.**
Rachel Dzombak, Ebru Kasikaralar, and Heather E. Dillon
Resources, Conservation & Recycling: X 6 (2020): 100022.

WORKING PAPERS

- **Dynamic Skill-Based Routing for Call Centers with Transfers: A Value-Based Framework.**
Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- A Discrete-Time Batch Simulation Framework for Rapid Scenario Planning in Large-Scale Contact Centers
 - 2026 Amazon Machine Learning Conference Workshop on Capacity Planning: Optimization, Simulation and Agentic AI, Seattle, WA. (*upcoming*)
 - 2026 Amazon Fulfillment Simulation Symposium, Seattle, WA.
- Dynamic Scheduling of a Parallel-Server Queueing System: A Computational Method for High-Dimensional Problems
 - 2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA. (*upcoming*)
 - 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA.
 - 2025 Amazon OptimiST Learning Session, Seattle, WA.
- Dynamic Scheduling of a Multiclass Queue in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems
 - 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA.
 - 2025 Amazon OptimiST Learning Session, Seattle, WA.
 - 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA.
 - 2024 Stochastic Networks Conference, Stockholm, Sweden.
 - 2024 Stanford MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, Stanford, CA.
 - 2023 Chicago Booth Operations Day, Chicago, IL.
 - 2023 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Teaching Assistant

Operations Management (Executive MBA) <i>London, Hong Kong, Chicago</i>	<i>Winter 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025</i>
Managerial Decision Modeling (Executive MBA) <i>Chicago</i>	<i>Summer 2021</i>
Managerial Decision Modeling (Undergraduate)	<i>Spring 2021, 2022</i>

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Best Innovator & Change Agent Award, Amazon Customer Service 2025
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business
Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in Chicago 2025
- J. Michael Harrison Doctoral Prize, Booth School of Business 2024
Doctoral student enrolled at Chicago Booth whose research is judged to make the most impactful contribution to theory
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business 2023
Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in London
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business 2023
Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in Hong Kong
- Katherine Dusak Miller PhD Fellowship 2024 – 2025
- Ph.D. Fellowship, Booth School of Business 2019 – 2024

- Honors in Industrial Engineering and Operations Research, UC Berkeley 2019
- URAP Summer Research Fellowship, Haas School of Business 2018
- Silver Medal in Science Category, GENIUS Project Olympiad, *Syracuse, NY* 2013
- Bronze Medal in Environmental Category, I-SWEEEP Project Olympiad, *Houston, TX* 2013

PROJECTS

- **Amazon.com, Inc.**, Seattle, WA 2026
A Discrete-Time Batch Simulation Framework for Rapid Scenario Planning in Large-Scale Contact Centers
Designed a discrete-time simulation framework that models end-to-end customer journeys, from self-service to resolution in the contact center, as a Markov chain. Its runtime scales with the number of time steps rather than with contact volume as in a discrete-event simulation, and it has been adopted for peak-season planning.
- **United States Postal Service**, Oakland, CA 2019
Optimization of Package Zip Code Sorting Assignment at APBS Machines
Optimized the package sorting process at the Oakland regional distribution center with a matching model formulated as a mixed integer linear program, significantly reducing the steps required by the workforce.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- **Referee:** *Queueing Systems*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Programming skills:** Python (TensorFlow, PyTorch), C++, Julia, MATLAB, R, AMPL.
- **Languages:** Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Spanish (beginner), Italian (beginner).
- **Hobbies/Interests:** Photography, Piano, Classical Music (Chopin, Tchaikovsky, Satie), Ukulele, Sailing, Windsurfing.
- **Nationality:** Turkish, U.S. Permanent Resident.